



CONTINGENCY LESSONS

Reading for SylvanSync™

Early Elementary



GRADES 1-2

TO BE USED ONLY IN CASE OF EMERGENCY, WITH THE APPROVAL OF TECHNOLOGY SERVICES.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
VersaTiles: Match Uppercase and Lowercase Letters

Objectives

The student will be able to:

- match lowercase and uppercase letters.
- discriminate among similar lowercase and uppercase letter forms.
- identify corresponding lowercase and uppercase letters.

Materials

- *VersaTiles: Alphabet Sounds and Letters* book (VT1ASL)
- VersaTiles

Background Information

VersaTiles let you learn, practice, and review skills all by yourself! Start by opening the Answer Case. Place the number tiles on the top half of the case with the number side up. The letters A–L will be on the bottom. Answer the questions in your activity book, close the case and flip it over, and check to see if your answers match. VersaTiles activities can help you learn about sounds and letters, and practice reading and vocabulary!

In this lesson, you will be **matching letters**, which means that you will look at one letter form and find another one exactly like it. When you match letters with VersaTiles, you will know you did it correctly if the uppercase letters in the corner are in alphabetical order.

Reading for SylvanSync™**Grades 1–2****VersaTiles: Match Uppercase and Lowercase Letters****Activity****Part 1**

Go to page 2 in *VersaTiles: Alphabet Sounds and Letters*. Match the lowercase letters. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Part 2

Go to page 5 in *VersaTiles: Alphabet Sounds and Letters*. Match the uppercase letters. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Part 3

Go to page 6 in *VersaTiles: Alphabet Sounds and Letters*. Match the lowercase letters with their uppercase letter partners. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Part 4

Go to page 7 in *VersaTiles: Alphabet Sounds and Letters*. Match the uppercase letters with their lowercase letter partners. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
VersaTiles: Word Match

Objectives

The student will be able to:

- recognize simple high-frequency words with similar letter forms.
- use picture clues.
- identify short vowel words and pictures.

Materials

- *VersaTiles: Alphabet Sounds and Letters* book (VT1ASL)
- VersaTiles

Background Information

VersaTiles let you learn, practice, and review skills all by yourself! Start by opening the Answer Case. Place the number tiles on the top half of the case with the number side up. The letters A–L will be on the bottom. Answer the questions in your activity book, close the case and flip it over, and check to see if your answers match. VersaTiles activities can help you learn about sounds and letters, and practice reading and vocabulary!

In this lesson, you will be looking closely at each letter in a word, and then matching words. When you match words with VersaTiles, you will know you did it correctly if the uppercase letters in the corner are in alphabetical order.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
VersaTiles: Word Match

Activity

Part 1

Go to page 8 in *VersaTiles: Alphabet Sounds and Letters*. Match the pictures. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Part 2

Go to page 9 in *VersaTiles: Alphabet Sounds and Letters*. Match the small words. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Part 3

Go to page 19 in *VersaTiles: Alphabet Sounds and Letters*. Match the words with their pictures. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Part 4

Go to page 24 in *VersaTiles: Alphabet Sounds and Letters*. Match the words with their pictures. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
VersaTiles: Consonant Sounds

Objectives

The student will be able to:

- use picture clues.
- identify letters that stand for initial consonant sounds.
- identify letters that stand for final consonant sounds.

Materials

- *VersaTiles: Alphabet Sounds and Letters* book (VT1ASL)
- *VersaTiles: Sounds and Letters* book (VT1FSL)
- VersaTiles

Background Information

VersaTiles let you learn, practice, and review skills all by yourself! Start by opening the Answer Case. Place the number tiles on the top half of the case with the number side up. The letters A–L will be on the bottom. Answer the questions in your activity book, close the case and flip it over, and check to see if your answers match. VersaTiles activities can help you learn about sounds and letters, and practice reading and vocabulary!

In this lesson, you will find letters that stand for consonant sounds. You will know you did chose correctly if the uppercase letters in the corner are in alphabetical order.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
VersaTiles: Consonant Sounds

Activity

Part 1

Go to page 13 in *VersaTiles: Alphabet Sounds and Letters*. Match the pictures to the letter that makes the first sound. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Part 2

Go to page 15 in *VersaTiles: Alphabet Sounds and Letters*. Match the pictures to the letter that makes the final sound. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Part 3

Go to page 1 in *VersaTiles: Sounds and Letters*. Match the pictures to the letter that makes the first sound. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Part 4

Go to page 2 in *VersaTiles: Sounds and Letters*. Match the pictures to the letter that makes the final sound. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
VersaTiles: Digraphs

Objectives

The student will be able to:

- use picture and graphophonic clues.
- identify words with initial digraphs.
- identify words with final digraphs.

Materials

- *VersaTiles: Sounds and Letters* book (VT1SL)
- *VersaTiles: Fun with Sounds and Letters* book (VT1FSL)
- VersaTiles

Background Information

VersaTiles let you learn, practice, and review skills all by yourself! Start by opening the Answer Case. Place the number tiles on the top half of the case with the number side up. The letters A–L will be on the bottom. Answer the questions in your activity book, close the case and flip it over, and check to see if your answers match. VersaTiles activities can help you learn about sounds and letters, and practice reading and vocabulary!

In this lesson, use picture clues and find words with digraphs. With VersaTiles, you will know you did it correctly if the uppercase letters in the corner are in alphabetical order.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
VersaTiles: Digraphs

Activity

Part 1

Go to page 11 in *VersaTiles: Sounds and Letters*. Match the pictures to the name. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Part 2

Go to page 12 in *VersaTiles: Sounds and Letters*. Match the pictures to the name. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Part 3

Go to page 13 in *VersaTiles: Sounds and Letters*. Read each clue and answer the questions. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Part 4

Go to page 22 in *VersaTiles: Fun with Sounds and Letters*. Use the letter blends to think of words that fill in the blanks. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
VersaTiles: Predictions and Cause and Effect

Objectives

The student will be able to:

- make predictions.
- identify cause and effect relationships.
- use picture clues.

Materials

- *VersaTiles: Read to Understand* book (VT2RU)
- VersaTiles

Background Information

VersaTiles let you learn, practice, and review skills all by yourself! Start by opening the Answer Case. Place the number tiles on the top half of the case with the number side up. The letters A–L will be on the bottom. Answer the questions in your activity book, close the case and flip it over, and check to see if your answers match. VersaTiles activities can help you learn about sounds and letters, and practice reading and vocabulary!

In this lesson, you will practice making predictions and figuring out cause and effect. With VersaTiles, you will know you did it correctly if the uppercase letters in the corner are in alphabetical order.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
VersaTiles: Predictions and Cause and Effect

Activity

Part 1

Go to page 3 in *VersaTiles: Read to Understand*. For numbers 1–6, tell what will happen if the object is put in water. For numbers 7–12, tell what will happen if the object is put in the sun. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Part 2

Go to pages 4–5 in *VersaTiles: Read to Understand*. Read each fairy tale. Finish each sentence to help the hero out of the problem. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Part 3

Go to pages 6 in *VersaTiles: Read to Understand*. Choose the picture that shows what happened next. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Part 4

Go to page 7 in *VersaTiles: Read to Understand*. Look at each picture. Find the sentence that tells what happened just before. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Part 4

Go to page 8 in *VersaTiles: Read to Understand*. Read each sentence. Find the sentence that tells what happened next. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
VersaTiles: Spelling

Objectives

The student will be able to:

- proofread and correct spelling of words.
- recognize and spell high frequency words.

Materials

- *VersaTiles: Ready! Set! Spell!* book (VT2RSS)
- VersaTiles

Background Information

VersaTiles let you learn, practice, and review skills all by yourself! Start by opening the Answer Case. Place the number tiles on the top half of the case with the number side up. The letters A–L will be on the bottom. Answer the questions in your activity book, close the case and flip it over, and check to see if your answers match. VersaTiles activities can help you learn about sounds and letters, and practice reading and vocabulary!

In this lesson, you will practice spelling. With VersaTiles, you will know you did it correctly if the uppercase letters in the corner are in alphabetical order.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
VersaTiles: Spelling

Activity

Part 1

Go to page 7 in *VersaTiles: Ready! Set! Spell!* Look at the word that is spelled wrong. Find the letter or letters to make it right. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Part 2

Go to page 8 in *VersaTiles: Ready! Set! Spell!* Look at each word shape. Find the word that fits the shape. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Part 3

Go to page 15 in *VersaTiles: Ready! Set! Spell!* Look at the word that is spelled wrong. Choose the letter to replace the one in color. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Part 4

Go to page 17 in *VersaTiles: Ready! Set! Spell!* Look at each word shape. Find the word that fits the shape. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
VersaTiles: Sequence and Inferences

Objectives

The student will be able to:

- determine the sequence of items and events.
- make inferences.
- use picture clues.

Materials

- *VersaTiles: Reading for Meaning* (VT2RFM)
- VersaTiles

Background Information

VersaTiles let you learn, practice, and review skills all by yourself! Start by opening the Answer Case. Place the number tiles on the top half of the case with the number side up. The letters A–L will be on the bottom. Answer the questions in your activity book, close the case and flip it over, and check to see if your answers match. VersaTiles activities can help you learn about sounds and letters, and practice reading and vocabulary!

In this lesson, you will use picture clues to help you figure out the sequence of items and events and make inferences. With VersaTiles, you will know you did it correctly if the uppercase letters in the corner are in alphabetical order.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
VersaTiles: Sequence and Inferences

Activity

Part 1

Go to page 11 in *VersaTiles: Reading for Meaning*. Put the pictures in order. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Part 2

Go to page 12 in *VersaTiles: Reading for Meaning*. Look at the pictures. Then put them in the correct order. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Part 3

Go to page 13 in *VersaTiles: Reading for Meaning*. Read each set of sentences. Then put them in order. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Part 4

Go to pages 14–15 in *VersaTiles: Reading for Meaning*. Look at each picture. Then find the words in the Answer Box on page 15 that tell about each picture. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Part 5

Go to page 16 in *VersaTiles: Reading for Meaning*. Read each riddle. Then find the picture in the Answer Box that answers the riddle. Flip over the box to see if you did it correctly.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 1–2

Story Summary 1

Objectives

The student will be able to:

- write a brief summary of a fictional story.
- create flash cards for any unfamiliar vocabulary.
- study the new vocabulary words.

Materials

- three index cards (or blank paper)
- crayons or markers

Background Information

Realistic fiction is a make-believe story about something that could happen in real life. The story isn't actually true, but it seems as though it could be.

When you write a **summary** about a fictional story, you should retell the story in your own words. State the **main idea** of the story, and two or three **details** that tell about the important events in the story.

Activity

Complete the activities that follow on index cards or a separate sheet of paper.

First, make some flash cards for a few words from the story you might not know yet. Then read the story. It is an example of realistic fiction. Finally, write a summary of the story and review your flash cards.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
Story Summary 1

Part 1

Make flash cards for some of the new vocabulary words you will read in the story.

1. Make one flash card at a time.
 2. Write one of the words below.
 3. Flip the card over and write the definition on the other side.
- **separate** (adjective) not shared with somebody or something else; distinct
 - **exclaim** (verb) to speak or cry out loudly and suddenly, in surprise or excitement
 - **dilemma** (noun) when someone must choose between two or more equally good options

Write three sentences. Use one of the words above in each sentence.

Part 2

Read the story below.

The New Puppy

Kristin and Trevor are twins. Each year on their birthday, Kristin and Trevor get separate cakes. Kristin does not like chocolate. Trevor does not like vanilla. Sitting at opposite ends of the table, they lean over their cakes to make a wish. Year after year, Kristin and Trevor secretly wished for the same thing. Their eyes closed tightly, they would think, "I wish for a puppy." Kristin and Trevor never told each other what they wished for.

This year, their mom gave each of them a small gift. Kristin eagerly tore the paper off of her present. Opening the box, she looked confused. "It's . . . a bone," said Kristin. Unlike Kristin, Trevor carefully opened his gift. With a huge smile on his face, Trevor held up his present. "It's a dog leash!" he cried. "Kristin! We're getting a puppy!"

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
Story Summary 1

"Just what I've always wished for!" they exclaimed at the same time. Kristin and Trevor looked at each other and laughed.

The next day, Kristin and Trevor went to the pound with their mother. Kristin spotted a tiny poodle right away.

"I think we should get that poodle! It's as cute as a button!" she said. Trevor was already across the room. He had found a sheepdog. "No way!" cried Trevor. "I want this sheepdog! Big dogs are better."

Kristin and Trevor each looked at their mom for help. She just shrugged, "You need to work this out on your own."

"Hmmm... I know! Why don't we toss a coin?" said Trevor.

"Okay! If it lands on heads, we get my poodle," said Kristin. "If it lands on tails, we get your sheepdog."

Trevor tossed the coin. As it sailed through the air, he reached to grab it, but he missed! The coin rolled across the room. Kristin quickly ran to get it. Leaning over to pick up the coin, Kristin felt a wet tongue lick the side of her face.

"Trevor! Come here!" she cried. Trevor ran over. In front of them sat a cute little puppy with white, curly fur and little, brown ears.

It wagged its tail and looked happily at the twins. "Are you thinking what I'm thinking?" they said at the same time. Kristin and Trevor smiled at each other. "Well, I guess the dilemma is solved!" laughed their mother.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
Story Summary 1

Now answer these questions.

1. What is the main idea of this story?
 - a. The twins both want a puppy, and they get one for their birthday.
 - b. The twins have a fight about getting a sheepdog or a poodle on their birthday.
 - c. The twins can't decide on what puppy to get, so their mother says they can't have one.
 - d. The twins have always wanted a puppy, but on their birthday they get a bone and a leash instead.
2. What are some details that support the main idea?
3. In your own words, summarize this story.

Part 3

Now practice your new vocabulary words. Hold up one flash card at a time. If you see the word side of the flash card, say the definition quietly to yourself. If you see the definition side, say the word being defined.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 1–2

Story Summary 2

Objectives

The student will be able to:

- write a brief summary of a fictional story.
- create flash cards for any unfamiliar vocabulary.
- study the new vocabulary words.

Materials

- three index cards (or blank paper)
- crayons or markers

Background Information

A **fairy tale** is a magical story about imagined places and characters.

When you write a **summary** about a fictional story, you should retell the story in your own words. State the **main idea** of the story, and two or three **details** that tell about the important events of the story.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
Story Summary 2

Activity

Complete the activities that follow on index cards or a separate sheet of paper.

First, make some flash cards for a few words from the story you might not know yet. Then read the story. It is an example of a fairy tale. Finally, write a summary of the story and review your flash cards.

Part 1

Make flash cards for some of the new vocabulary words you will read in the story.

- Make one flash card at a time.
- Write one of the words below.
- Flip the card over and write the definition on the other side.

- **imprison** (verb) to lock someone away, as in a prison
- **startle** (verb) to frighten with a sudden surprise
- **eventually** (adverb) after a long time

Write three sentences. Use one of the words above in each sentence.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
Story Summary 2

Part 2

Read the story below.

The Story of Rapunzel

Rapunzel was a princess with long, golden hair. She was imprisoned in a tower in the woods by a bad witch. The witch would visit Rapunzel to bring her food. When she visited Rapunzel, she would call out, “Rapunzel! Rapunzel! Let down your hair!” Then she would climb Rapunzel’s hair like a ladder.

After two years, the king’s son happened to ride by Rapunzel’s tower. He heard a beautiful song, for Rapunzel sang and sang to pass her days. The prince tried to find the door to the tower, but he couldn’t. Every day, he came back to the woods to hear Rapunzel’s songs.

One day, while in the woods enjoying the joyous songs of Rapunzel, the prince heard the witch call, “Rapunzel! Rapunzel! Let down your hair!” He watched from behind a tree as the witch climbed Rapunzel’s long, golden braids up to the window.

The next morning, the prince went to the tower and called out, “Rapunzel! Rapunzel! Let down your hair!” She threw down her long, silky braids, and the prince climbed up. Rapunzel was startled to see the young man, and not the witch! The prince told Rapunzel that he had been listening to her songs and that he enjoyed them very much. The two had a wonderful conversation, and they became friends. Eventually, the prince helped Rapunzel escape from the tower.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
Story Summary 2

Now answer these questions.

1. What is the main idea of this story?
2. The prince loves the sound of Rapunzel's singing.

TRUE

FALSE

3. In your own words, summarize this story.

Part 3

Now practice your new vocabulary words. Hold up one flash card at a time. If you see the word side of the flash card, say the definition quietly to yourself. If you see the definition side, say the word being defined.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
Nonfiction Article Summary 1 (Social Studies)

Objectives

The student will be able to:

- write a brief summary of a nonfiction article.
- create flash cards for any unfamiliar vocabulary.
- study the new vocabulary words.

Materials

- two index cards (or blank paper)
- crayons or markers

Background Information

A **nonfiction article** is a short written piece about something that is true. Nonfiction articles can be about real people, places, objects, or events. You would read nonfiction articles in newspapers or magazines.

When you write a **summary** about a nonfiction article, you should retell the important parts of the article in your own words. State the **main idea** of the article, and two or three important **facts** that support the main idea.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
Nonfiction Article Summary 1 (Social Studies)

Activity

Complete the activities that follow on index cards or a separate sheet of paper.

First, make some flash cards for a few words from the article you might not know yet. Then read the article. It is an example of nonfiction. Finally, write a summary of the article and review your flash cards.

Part 1

Make flash cards for some of the new vocabulary words you will read in the article.

1. Make one flash card at a time.
2. Write one of the words below.
3. Flip the card over and write the definition on the other side.
 - **prickly** (adjective) having sharp pointy things on the surface
 - **invent** (verb) to be the first to think of and make

Write two sentences. Use one of the words above in each sentence.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
Nonfiction Article Summary 1 (Social Studies)

Part 2

Read the article below.

The Story of Velcro

Look at your shoes. Do you have laces? Do you have Velcro straps? Many people have Velcro straps on their shoes. Velcro was invented by a man named George de Mestral. George liked to go for walks. Sometimes he walked through weeds. Sometimes he walked through tall grass. When he came home, he had prickly plants called cockleburrs stuck on his clothes.

One day George pulled a cocklebur out of his sock. He looked at it. George was curious. George wanted to learn. He wanted to see why the cocklebur stuck to his clothes. George saw that the cocklebur had strips with hooks on the ends. These hooks made it stick to cloth and fur. The hooks gave George an idea.

He made something like a cocklebur. It had two strips of cloth. One strip had small hooks on the ends. The other strip had loops. The hooks catch the loops when the pieces are pressed together. George named it Velcro.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
Nonfiction Article Summary 1 (Social Studies)

Now answer these questions.

1. Choose the main idea of the article and write it on your paper.

George de Mestral invented Velcro after studying the cocklebur.

George de Mestral was curious about cockleburs sticking to his socks.

2. Velcro has one strip with hooks and one strip with loops?

TRUE

FALSE

3. No one would have sneakers today if it weren't for George de Mestral.

TRUE

FALSE

4. In your own words, summarize this article. Remember to write the main idea and two or three important details from the article.

Part 3

Now practice your new vocabulary words. Hold up one flash card at a time. If you see the word side of the flash card, say the definition quietly to yourself. If you see the definition side, say the word being defined.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
Nonfiction Article Summary 2 (Science)

Objectives

The student will be able to:

- write a brief summary of a nonfiction article.
- create flash cards for any unfamiliar vocabulary.
- study the new vocabulary words.

Materials

- three index cards (or blank paper)
- crayons or markers

Background Information

A **nonfiction article** is a short written piece about something that is true. Nonfiction articles can be about real people, places, objects, or events. You would read nonfiction articles in newspapers or magazines.

When you write a **summary** about a nonfiction article, you should retell the important parts of the article in your own words. State the **main idea** of the article, and two or three important **facts** that support the main idea.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
Nonfiction Article Summary 2 (Science)

Activity

Complete the activities that follow on index card or a separate sheet of paper.

First, make some flash cards for a few words from the article you might not know yet. Then read the article. It is an example of nonfiction. Finally, write a summary of the article and review your flash cards.

Part 1

Make flash cards for some of the new vocabulary words you will read in the article.

1. Make one flash card at a time.
2. Write one of the words below.
3. Flip the card over and write the definition on the other side.
 - **rough** (adjective) having a bumpy surface; not smooth
 - **sandpaper** (noun) strong paper coated with pieces of sand; used to smooth out wood
 - **extinct** (adjective) when all members of a species have died out; such as dinosaurs

Write three sentences. Use one of the words above in each sentence.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
Nonfiction Article Summary 2 (Science)

Part 2

Read the article below.

Sharks!

Sharks are very cool animals. They are different from other fish. Sharks do not have bones in their bodies. Other fish have bones. Fish with bones have smooth bodies. Sharks have very rough bodies. If you rubbed against a shark, you could get scraped! Sharks only swim forward in the water. Many fish can swim forward and backward.

One of the biggest sharks is called the great white shark. It eats other fish and sharks. It has many sharp teeth that are shaped like triangles. The body of the great white shark is gray and blue. Its stomach is white. Its skin is hard and strong. It feels like sandpaper.

You can find sharks all over the world. The number of sharks is getting smaller because people hunt sharks. People hunt sharks for food but also for fun. It is up to people to protect sharks. If we do not, they will become extinct.

Now answer these questions.

1. What is the main idea of the article?
 - a. Sharks have rough skin.
 - b. Sharks can't swim backwards.
 - c. Sharks are very cool animals.
 - d. Sharks will go extinct if we don't save them.
2. Sharks eat other fish.

TRUE

FALSE

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
Nonfiction Article Summary 2 (Science)

3. Sharks don't have any bones.

TRUE

FALSE

4. In your own words, summarize this article. Remember to include the main idea and two or three important details from the article.

Part 3

Now practice your new vocabulary words. Hold up one flash card at a time. If you see the word side of the flash card, say the definition quietly to yourself. If you see the definition side, say the word being defined.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
Travel Brochure

Objectives

The student will be able to:

- read and describe the features of a travel brochure.
- write and illustrate a travel brochure for your hometown.

Materials

- paper
- markers
- crayons

Background Information

A **travel brochure** is a kind of advertisement. People from hotels, different states, and even whole countries make them. They want people to come visit! Travel brochures describe the best parts of a place. That makes people want to go there. Travel brochures might describe parks, beaches, museums, and arts of the area. There will be pictures of the most beautiful things to see there. There could also be maps.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
Travel Brochure

Activity

Complete the activities that follow on a separate sheet of paper.

In this lesson you will read and describe a travel brochure. Then you will make a travel brochure for your own hometown!

Part 1

Look at the travel brochure below.

 Come and experience natural beauty the way it was meant to be seen! Yosemite National Park is one of the FIRST National Parks in the United States. The waterfalls here are like nowhere else in the world! Hike, climb, camp, enjoy!	 Vacations the way they should be. In the peace and quiet of the natural world, with only the sound of waterfalls and birds in your ears. <i>Brought to you by California Vacations</i>
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Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
Travel Brochure

Now answer these questions.

1. What is Yosemite?
 - a. a national park
 - b. a state
 - c. a travel brochure
 - d. a waterfall

2. Where is Yosemite?

3. There are waterfalls at Yosemite.
TRUE FALSE

4. Describe what you might see if you visited Yosemite.

Part 2

Think about your hometown. What is your favorite place to visit there? Is there something very beautiful in your town? What is it? Does your town have a good museum, library, or historic monument? What might visitors do if they came there? On your paper, write a list of three things to do or see in your town.

Part 3

Make a travel brochure of your hometown. Use the details from your list. Describe the places on your list in short sentences. Make sure to include fun places to visit, eat, or relax. Draw pictures of the most beautiful places in your town.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 1–2

Character Portrait

Objectives

The student will be able to:

- analyze a photograph of a person.
- fill in a character map.
- write a description of that person, including physical features and what you think that person might be like.

Materials

- pencils or pens

Background Information

Photographs can tell you a lot about a person. There is an expression: A picture is worth a thousand words. This expression means that you can sometimes imagine an entire story just by looking at a picture.

A **character map** is used to help you understand a character in a story or picture. You add facts and ideas to the character map just the way you add details to a plot or story map. Then you can write a description of the character.

Activity

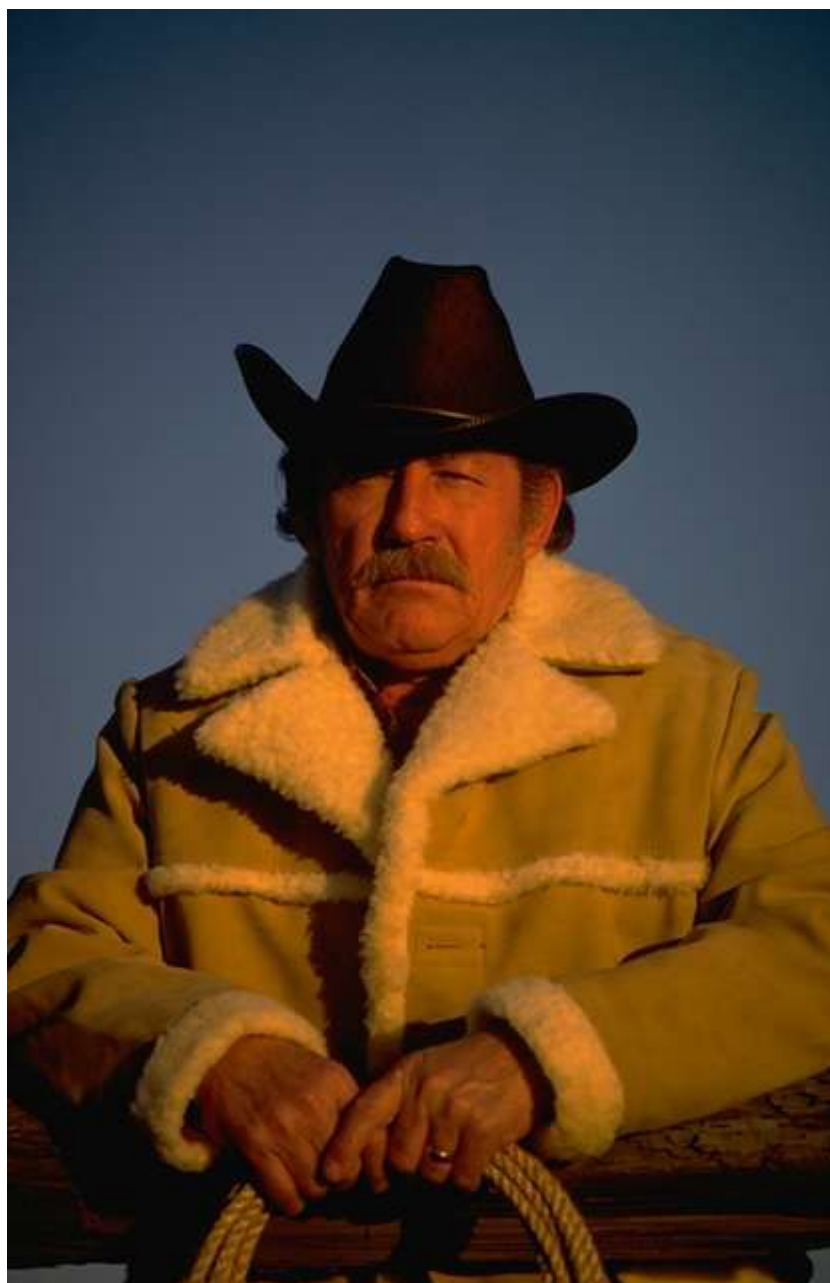
Complete the activities that follow on a separate sheet of paper.

First, look at the picture and think about what you can tell about the person in it. Then fill in a character map with facts and ideas you have about the person. Finally, write a description of the character in the picture.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
Character Portrait

Part 1

Look at this picture.



Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
Character Portrait

Now answer the questions.

1. Is this a picture of a man or a woman?
2. Which of these is probably the person's job?
 - a. cowboy
 - b. office worker
 - c. teacher
 - d. waiter
3. How do you think this person is feeling?
4. This person is married.

TRUE

FALSE

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
Character Portrait

Part 2

Copy the character map below onto your paper. Then fill in the map.

A character portrait map consisting of a central oval labeled "Character" connected to four rectangular boxes. The boxes are labeled "Feelings" (top-left), "Description" (top-right), "Behavior" (bottom-left), and "Personality Traits" (bottom-right).

Feelings	Description
Character	
Behavior	Personality Traits

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
Character Portrait

Part 3

Now write a description of the character in the picture.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 1–2

Funny Story

Objectives

The student will be able to:

- summarize a humorous story.
- analyze what makes the story funny.
- write a funny story (fiction or nonfiction).

Materials

- blank paper
- lined paper
- crayons or markers

Background Information

A **humorous story** is a short story in which something funny happens. A humorous story makes you laugh when you read it.

When you **analyze** a humorous story, you will think about what made it funny. Did one of the characters say something funny? Did something surprising and funny happen in the story? Was one of the characters tricked or fooled in a way that makes you laugh?

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
Funny Story

Activity

Complete the activities that follow on a separate sheet of paper.

First, read the humorous story in this lesson. Think about what makes it funny. Then answer some questions before writing your own humorous story.

Part 1

Read this story.

Chapter 2: Animal Language

adapted from *The Story of Doctor Dolittle*
by Hugh Lofting

One day Doctor Dolittle was talking with a sick man.

“Why don't you give up being a people's doctor? Be an animal doctor,” said the man.

The parrot was sitting in the window. She looked out at the rain and sang a song. Then she stopped singing. She started to listen.

“Doctor,” the man said, “you know all about animals. That book you wrote about cats is wonderful! You might be a cat yourself. You know the way they think. Be an animal doctor.”

The man left. The parrot flew off the window. She landed on the Doctor's table. Then she spoke!

“That man is smart. Be an animal doctor. Don't take care of silly people. Take care of animals instead.”

“There are plenty of animal doctors,” said Doctor Dolittle.

“Yes,” said the parrot. “But none of them are any good. I'll tell you something. Did you know that animals can talk?”

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
Funny Story

“You have never talked to me before!” said the Doctor.

So that was the way the Doctor came to know that animals could talk. That afternoon, the dog came in.

The parrot said, “See, he’s talking to you.”

“He is scratching his ear,” said the Doctor.

“But animals don't speak only with their mouths,” said the parrot. “They talk with their ears, their feet, and their tails. Do you see now the way he's twitching his nose?”

“What does that mean?” asked the Doctor.

“That means, ‘Did you know that I have to use the potty?’” said the parrot. “He is asking you a question. Dogs always use their noses to ask questions.”

After a while, the Doctor learned the language of the animals. Then he gave up being a people's doctor altogether.

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Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
Funny Story

Part 2

Now answer these questions on a separate sheet of paper.

1. Were you surprised when the parrot spoke to the Doctor?

YES

NO

2. Which sentence from the story is most funny?

Take care of animals instead.

Dogs always use their noses to ask questions.

The parrot flew off the window.

3. Did you think it was funny when the parrot said the dog was talking, but the doctor thought he was scratching his ear?

YES

NO

4. Did this story make you laugh?

YES

NO

5. If yes, what did you think was funny? Write some sentences on your paper.

Part 3

1. Now think about something funny. It can be something that really happened to you. Or it can be something you make up. Write about the funny thing in one or two sentences.
2. Think about how to tell a story about the funny thing that happened. Who should the funny thing happen to? Who are the characters in your story? Where does the story happen? Write some ideas on your paper.
3. Now write your humorous story. Read it to yourself. Did it make you laugh?

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
Comparative Literature

Objectives

The student will be able to:

- compare and contrast two fables.
- write and illustrate a fable.

Materials

- blank paper
- lined paper
- crayons or markers

Background Information

A **fable** is a short story that usually has animals as the characters. A fable always has a moral at the end. A **moral** is a rule that helps people remember the best way to behave.

When you **compare** two or more fables, you think about the characters in each story. How are they the same? How are they different? You also think about the morals of each story. Sometimes the fables you compare will have the same moral. Sometimes they will have different morals.

Activity

Complete the activities that follow on a separate sheet of paper.

First, read the fables in this lesson. Think about the characters in each story. Think about the morals in each story. Then answer some questions. Finally, think of a rule you believe is important. It should be something simple, that would help people remember how to behave. Then, write a fable that ends with your moral.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
Comparative Literature

Part 1

Read these fables.

The Ant and the Dove

An ant went to the river to get a drink. He fell in the water and was carried along in the stream. A dove saw the ant and felt sorry for him. She threw a small branch into the water. The ant climbed on the branch and went to shore.

Later, the ant saw a hunter. The hunter was aiming his gun right at the dove! The ant stung the hunter in the foot sharply. The hunter dropped his gun, and the dove's life was saved.

It is important to be kind and helpful to those who are kind and helpful to you.

The Lion and the Mouse

Lion was woken up from his nap by a mouse running over his face. Rising up angrily, Lion caught Mouse and was about to eat him. Mouse begged, "If you spare my life, I will be sure to repay your kindness." Lion laughed at Mouse and let him go.

It happened shortly after this that Lion was caught by some hunters, who tied him up with thick ropes. Mouse, recognizing Lion's roar, came and chewed at the rope with his teeth until the rope broke. Mouse set Lion free. Mouse said, "You see, even a tiny little mouse can help a powerful lion, such as yourself."

Little friends can be great friends.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
Comparative Literature

Part 2

Now answer these questions.

1. What is the moral of the first fable?
 - a. The world can be scary.
 - b. An ant cannot save a dove.
 - c. A dove does not care about an ant.
 - d. It is right to help those who help you.
2. What is the moral of the second fable?
 - a. The mouse saved the lion's life.
 - b. A mouse and lion can never be friends.
 - c. Even a small friend can help a larger one.
 - d. The lion is mean for laughing at the mouse.
3. How are the morals of these fables alike?

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 1–2
Comparative Literature

Part 3

Now think about a rule you feel is important. It can be about sharing, giving, helping people in need, or making sure to act safely. It can be about anything you choose. Write your rule on your paper.

Think about how you might tell a story that would show your rule. In “The Lion and the Mouse,” Lion helped Mouse, Mouse returned the favor, and both creatures were saved. This shows the rule that it is right to help people who have helped you.

What could happen to your characters that would show your rule? Write some ideas on your paper.

Now, on your paper, write a fable. Make sure that it ends with your moral, or rule, that reminds people how to behave. Finally, illustrate your fable.